

4

LESSON

First day at school: listening comprehension

Week 1: Feelings and settling in · A formal listening task, then the transfer to their own experience

Can-do	I can understand the main ideas and specific details of a short animated extract, and write about my own feelings on a first day.
Grammar	Present simple for routine and for narration. Recycled I feel ... when Adjectives of attitude: protective, kind, strict.
Phonology	Listening for weak forms in connected speech, and for the difference between <i>is</i> and <i>is not</i> .
Lexis	clownfish, anemone, to brush, safe, shark, sea turtle, to explore, protective, strict, kind.
Feeds the final task	Listening is formative, but the transfer paragraph at the end is booklet section 5 material and a formal rehearsal of the long sentence.

Materials and preparation

Item	Source file in the Unit 1 bank	Prepare
Video	1. Emotions / Nemo First day To School.mp4	Cue it. You will play it three times, so have the two restart points noted.
Listening paper	1. Emotions / Listening Test Nemo first day to school.docx	The file holds a full version and a shortened version. Print 7 full and 4 shortened; the shortened one is the Tier 1 paper.
Script	Same file, SCRIPT section at the end	One copy for you. Project the two gap-fill lines at the correction stage.
Pre-teach cards	Build: ten picture or word cards	clownfish, anemone, brush, safe, shark, sea turtle, explore, protective, strict, kind.
Exit slips	Build: a slip of paper per student	Eleven slips, cut before the lesson.

Lesson flow, 55 minutes

Time	Stage	What happens	Teacher notes
0 to 6	Homework share	Three students read one of their long sentences from last night. The class identifies the two halves out loud: <i>the feeling</i> and <i>the situation</i> .	Pick a Tier 1 student as one of the three. The sentence will be simple and correct, which is exactly the point.
6 to 13	Pre-listening	Project a still from the extract. <i>Who is he? Where is he? How does he feel?</i> Then pre-teach the ten words with the cards. Finish with a prediction: <i>Is he happy or scared about school?</i> Hands up for each.	Pre-teaching is not optional with this cohort. Without <i>anemone</i> and <i>sea turtle</i> the beginners lose the thread in the first minute.
13 to 20	First viewing, gist	Play the whole extract. Pens down, no writing. Then question 1 (type of document) and question 2a (the fish's name).	Answers: a cartoon or animated movie extract; Nemo. Insist on pens down. They will try to write and will miss the gist.
20 to 32	Second viewing, detail	Play again. Students complete question 2b and 2c (the father is protective, the teacher looks kind), question 3 (why the day matters) and question 4, the four true or false items.	Answers for question 4: scared to go to school, false, he is excited; dreams of stingrays, false; classmates nervous, false, they are playful and curious; wants to explore the ocean, true.
32 to 39	Third viewing, close listening	Play only the two gap-fill lines, twice. <i>Now, what is the one thing we have to ... about the ocean?</i> and the answer. Then question 6, the two short answers.	Answers: remember; it is not safe; sharks and sea turtles; close, playful, but the father is very protective.
39 to 46	Correction	Whole-class correction with the script projected for the disputed items. For each true or false answer, require the line from the extract that proves it.	Requiring the proof line is what turns a guessing exercise into comprehension, and it previews the evidence habit needed in Week 4.
46 to 53	Transfer to self	<i>How do you feel on the first day of school?</i> Three sentences in the notebook, each one a long sentence with <i>when</i> or <i>because</i> . Then read them to a partner, who must name the strongest one.	Point out that Nemo is excited and Riley is nervous, and that both are normal. In an international school with new arrivals, this lands.

Time	Stage	What happens	Teacher notes
53 to 55	Exit ticket	On a slip at the door, each student writes one adjective and one when-clause, and hands it to you on the way out.	Eleven slips give you a clean picture of who has the structure before Week 2 builds on top of it.

On the board, and copied into the notebook

The video is **a cartoon**, not a documentary. The fish is **Nemo**.

Marlin **is** protective. The teacher **looks** kind. The classmates **are** playful and curious.

Prove it: *True, because the extract says ...*

On the first day of school, I feel ... because ... / when ...

Differentiation, 11 students in three working tiers

Tier	What they get	What success looks like today
Tier 1, support A0 to A1	The shortened listening paper that is already in the file: fewer options, two true or false items instead of four, no gap fill. Word bank on the desk. Two transfer sentences rather than three.	The shortened paper completed, and two long sentences about their own first day.
Tier 2, core A1 to A2	The full listening paper. Three transfer sentences.	At least seven of the ten items correct, and three two-clause sentences.
Tier 3, extend A2 to B1	The full paper, plus every true or false answer justified with a quotation from the extract. Transfer task extended: compare Nemo with Riley in two sentences.	Full marks on the paper with written justifications, and a comparison that uses a connector such as <i>but</i> or <i>whereas</i> .

Homework and assessment

Homework	Finish the transfer paragraph, five sentences minimum, and learn the Week 1 vocabulary list. A short spoken check opens Week 2 Lesson 1.
Assessment	The listening paper is the first formal comprehension mark of the year. Record it, but present it to students as practice rather than as a test. The exit slips are the real diagnostic: they tell you whether the long sentence survived a week.

Watch out for

Three viewings, with a different task each time. Playing it once and asking everything is what produces blank papers from the beginners. The gist viewing with pens down is the one teachers cut when time is short, and it is the one that makes the rest work.

Marlin speaks fast and overlaps Nemo. The gap-fill lines are clear, but the surrounding dialogue is not. Keep close listening to the two lines specified and do not improvise extra gaps.

The first-day topic may be live for some students. In a school with new arrivals every September, *homesick* is not an abstract vocabulary item. Keep the transfer task open enough that a student can write about excitement instead if they prefer.